

Tuesday, August 16

Today is our 8th Anniversary. Money is tight so we will wait for another year to celebrate. We do plan to get a subscription to Omni magazine as a small gift.

Peter slept at Mama's and Papa's. The house was quiet. We woke at the usual time, had breakfast and began to work, I on the writing project, Cheryl readying herself to take Peter swimming.

After lunch Cheryl and Matthew went to the grocery store for weekend supplies. Peter played outside with Erin until 2, ran some through the sprinkler in the back yard and then rested. When Cheryl got home I went to the University for some books.

The family went to Cheryl's parents for an anniversary supper, BBQ roast, coleslaw, potatoes, lefsa. Adolph Peters and Grandma and Grandpa Skarsgard were there. The Skarsgards have planned a trip to Vancouver with Andrew on Friday. Peter and I went to the park to play "pretend football." This was a game Peter and I had played this spring. Peter's aim was to pretend he is a soccer ball and run past me into the goal. The mosquitoes were heavy, and men were playing in the field. Instead, we watched a fastball game. Peter sat on my shoulders for most of the last inning and I stood. He asked to sit on a post. I asked if he was uncomfortable. He said, "No, I thought you might like to." He was most interested in the batters. A rusty cat played in the dirt by the umpire. When we returned Cheryl had taken her grandparents home. We left by 8:45.

At home Peter prepared for bed and I got him a bowl of Bran cereal. I read the part of The Hobbit where Bilbo rescues the dwarves from the elves by shipping them in empty barrels and sending them in the tunnel. At this point Peter was climbing his feet up the wall and nearly standing on his head.

I said, "Peter, turn around and lie properly. You're not listening and to know what's happening in this book you must listen. Tell me what is happening."

"Well," he said, "the dwarves are stuffed in barrels and Bilbo is with them in the dark tunnel, floating in icy water."

In the meantime Cheryl put Matthew to sleep. Peter had requested a kiss from her. I read in the living room. I heard some faint voices and then a long silence. Finally Cheryl came out. Peter had wanted her to spend the night. The time was 10:40. After a short guitar practise Cheryl went to bed and I phoned David Dick. He was asleep and sounded confused for a few minutes. We planned to get families together a week from this Sunday. I was in bed by 11:15.